Mapping Like A Pro

Turn any chart into a decision map — support, resistance and a 20-minute daily routine.

Format	PDF guide · read in one sitting
Best for	Traders and busy professionals trading around a job
You get	A repeatable routine you can run in under 20 minutes a day

Contents

1. Why mapping beats prediction

Most traders lose because they try to guess the next candle. Mapping does the opposite: you decide, in advance, where price is likely to react, what you will do at each of those levels, and what invalidates the idea. The chart stops being a guessing game and becomes a checklist.

The three questions a map answers

- Where is the market coming from — impulse or range?
- Where is the nearest area price has historically reacted to?
- What has to happen at that area before I am allowed to click?

If you cannot answer all three in one sentence, you do not have a trade — you have an opinion.

2. Building the higher-timeframe skeleton

Start every session on the daily chart, then H4, then H1. You are not looking for entries here — you are drawing the skeleton that every lower-timeframe decision hangs on.

Step by step

- Mark the last three obvious daily swing highs and swing lows.
- Draw zones, not lines: use the candle body cluster, then extend to the wick.
- Mark the weekly open, the daily open and the previous day's high and low.
- Label each zone as supply, demand or pivot — nothing else.

Daily	Structure and bias. Maximum 6 zones on the chart.
H4	Refinement. Where the daily zone actually starts.
H1	Trigger frame. Reaction confirmation only.

3. Support and resistance that actually hold

A level is only worth trading if price has left it in a hurry at least once. Slow, overlapping reactions produce zones that leak; sharp departures produce zones that hold.

Quality filter

- Departure: did price leave with a strong impulsive candle?
- Freshness: has the zone already been tapped twice? If yes, downgrade it.
- Confluence: does it line up with a round number, a session high/low or a moving average?
- Location: is there open space for the trade to run to the next zone?

Grade each zone A, B or C. Only A and B zones get real risk. C zones are for observation and journaling.

4. The 20-minute daily routine

This routine is designed for someone with a job. It runs before the London or New York open and needs no screen time during the session.

0–5 min	Refresh the daily and H4 map. Delete any level price has burned through.
5–10 min	Check the economic calendar. Note high-impact events and avoid entries 15 minutes either side.
10–15 min	Set alerts at every A and B zone. Never watch charts waiting for price.
15–20 min	Pre-write the plan: entry trigger, stop, first target, position size.

When an alert fires, you only have to execute a decision you already made calmly.

5. Entry triggers and confirmation

A zone tells you where. A trigger tells you when. Never enter on the touch alone.

Three triggers, ranked

- Reaction candle: engulfing or pin bar closing back inside the zone on the trigger timeframe.
- Structure shift: a lower-timeframe break of the last opposing swing after the tap.
- Retest entry: enter on the pullback into the broken structure — smallest stop, lowest hit rate.

Pick one trigger and use it for 50 trades before you judge it. Rotating triggers makes your data meaningless.

6. Risk, sizing and the maths that keeps you alive

Every trade risks a fixed fraction of the account — 0.5% while learning, 1% once you have 100 logged trades with a positive expectancy.

Position size	(Account × risk %) ÷ (stop distance in pips × pip value)
Expectancy	(Win rate × average win) – (Loss rate × average loss)
Daily stop	Two consecutive losses or –2% — whichever comes first. Then stop.

A 45% win rate at 1:2 risk-to-reward is profitable. A 70% win rate at 1:0.4 is not. Chase the ratio, not the streak.

7. Journaling and review

The map only improves if you feed it results. Log every trade the same day, in the same format.

- Screenshot of the map before entry, and after exit.
- Zone grade, trigger used, risk taken, result in R.
- One sentence: did I follow the plan? Yes or no — separate from win or loss.
- Weekly: count plan-followed trades. That percentage is your real skill score.

Review on Sunday. Remove one recurring mistake per week. That is the whole edge.